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MySQL Working With Dates

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MySQL Dates

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The most difficult part when working with dates in databases, is to be sure that the format of the date you are trying to insert/select, matches the format of the date column in the database.

MySQL Date Data Types

MySQL has the following data types for storing a date or a date/time value in the database:

- `DATE` - format YYYY-MM-DD
- `DATETIME` - format: YYYY-MM-DD HH:MI:SS
- `TIMESTAMP` - format: YYYY-MM-DD HH:MI:SS
- `TIME` - format: HH:MI:SS
- `YEAR` - format YYYY or YY

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MySQL Working with Dates

Look at the following table:

Orders Table

OrderId	ProductName	OrderDate
1	Geitost	2025-11-11
2	Camembert Pierrot	2025-11-09
3	Mozzarella di Giovanni	2025-11-11
4	Mascarpone Fabioli	2025-10-29

Now we want to select the records with an OrderDate of "2025-11-11" from the table above.

We use the following `SELECT` statement:

```
SELECT * FROM Orders WHERE OrderDate='2025-11-11'
```

The result-set will look like this:

OrderId	ProductName	OrderDate
1	Geitost	2025-11-11
3	Mozzarella di Giovanni	2025-11-11

Note: Two dates can easily be compared if there is no time component involved!

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OrderId	ProductName	OrderDate
1	Geitost	2025-11-11 13:23:44
2	Camembert Pierrot	2025-11-09 15:45:21
3	Mozzarella di Giovanni	2025-11-11 11:12:01
4	Mascarpone Fabioli	2025-10-29 14:56:59

If we use the same `SELECT` statement as above:

```
SELECT * FROM Orders WHERE OrderDate='2025-11-11'
```

we will get no result! This is because the query is looking only for dates with no time portion.

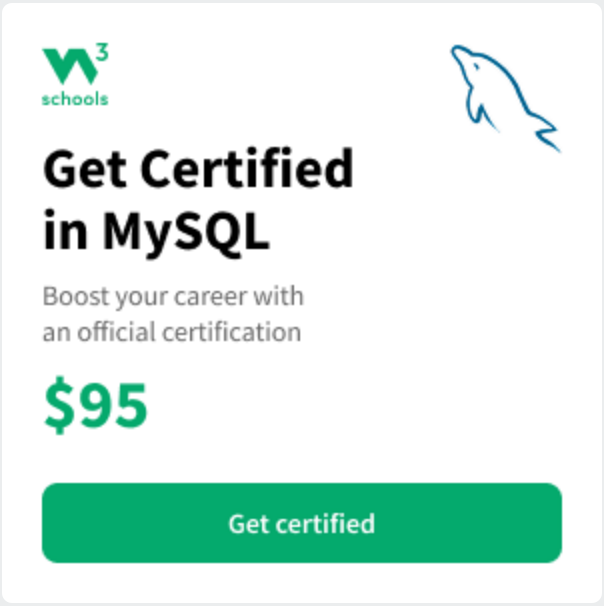
Tip: To keep your queries simple and easy to maintain, do not use time-components in your dates, unless you have to!

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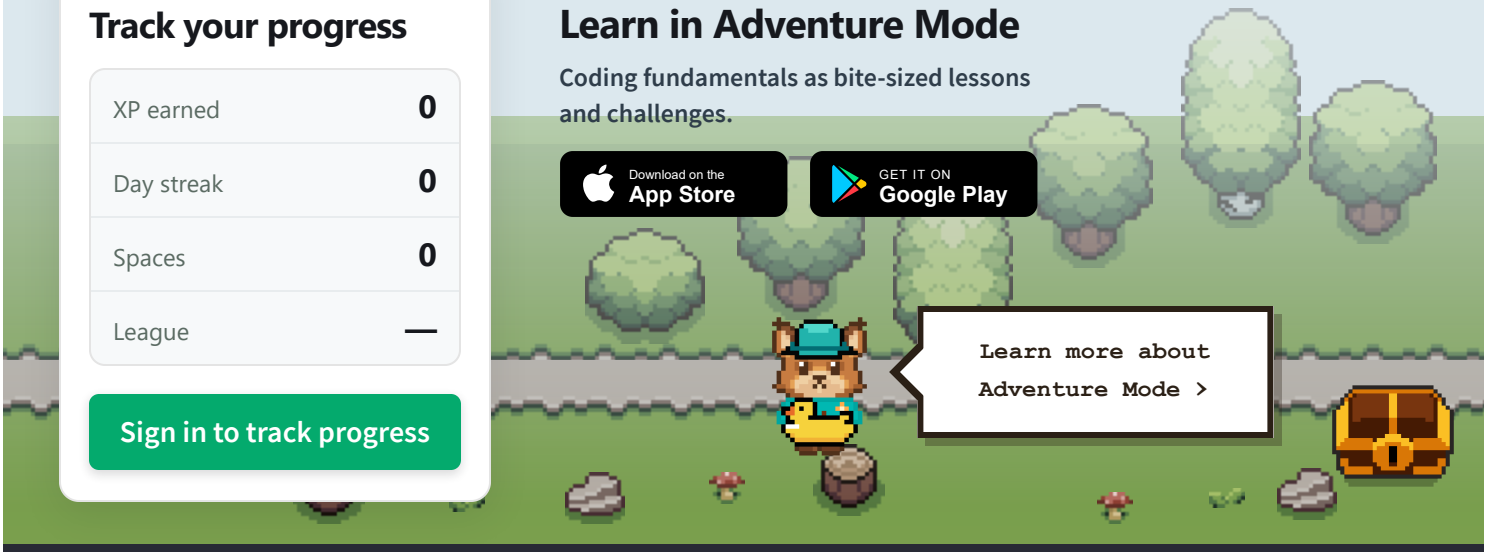


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